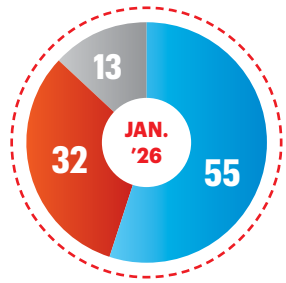
Q. Ladakhi innovator Sonam Wangchuk was detained under the National Security Act in September 2025 for allegedly inciting protests linked to demands for statehood for Ladakh—mobilisations marked by substantial participation from students and young people. Do you think invoking such stringent laws against movements with strong youth involvement is justified?



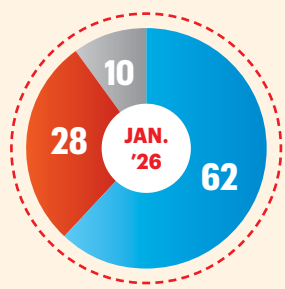
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- Yes, if there are credible risks of violence or public disorder, strict measures are justified
- No, this amounts to an overreach that suppresses democratic protest and youth-led dissent
- DK/ CS

Q. The banned Communist Party of India (Maoist) announced in September 2025 a suspension of armed insurgent activities and willingness to enter peace talks. In your view, should the government engage in peace negotiations with the Maoist insurgents?

- Yes, the government should seize the opportunity to negotiate a peace settlement
- No, the government should not negotiate with Maoists and instead continue security operations
- DK/ CS





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ships with neighbours, the verdict is mixed: 50.7 per cent believe ties have improved, but a substantial 46 per cent disagree. They are also equally divided over whether India has effectively countered Trump's claim that he brokered peace with Pakistan during Operation Sindoor. With China, the MOTN favours a dual approach of strengthening border security while enhancing trade relationships and pursuing diplomatic dialogue.

Less of a Failure

When it comes to the NDA government's failures, 'inflation' and 'unemployment' still figure on top, but with less intensity than before. Price rise remains the number one failure but is down from 21.2 per cent to 19.5 per cent in the previous MOTN. The drop of nearly 2 percentage points could be because the Modi government has lowered the rate of inflation significantly in the past year. What has also helped is the rationalising of the Goods and Services Tax, which saw easing of rates for many household goods and services categories, leading to lower prices. However, with only 22.6 per cent saying they are buying more after GST changes, the government needs to get more aggressive in its implementation.

The biggest fall is in concern over unemployment, which now figures at No. 2 in the list of failures and has dropped from a high 27.1 per cent to 16.6 per cent now. Validation comes from another MOTN finding, with the percentage of respondents who think the unemployment situation as 'serious' to 'very serious' falling from 71.5 in August 2025 to 64.8 now. Nearly 53 per cent also believe that the Modi government's initiatives have led to the creation of jobs, even as 41.1 per cent hold the opposite view. Interestingly, while the preference for government jobs has fallen from 48.5 per cent to 42.2 per cent this time, those wanting to run their own businesses have gone up from 34.7 per cent to 40.2 per cent, possibly indicating the growth of job opportunities in the gig economy. But the government will have to improve ease of doing business, with a majority still believing it's hard to start a business in India.

Yashwant Deshmukh, founder, CVoter, points to two possible reasons why the